

Panelists



Dhaval Chhedha, VP, Engineering,
Masai School



Lakshmi Mittra, VP & Head,
Clover Academy



Sunil David, Regional Director
of IoT, AT&T



Vinay Solanki, GM & Head
of Digital Solutions, Napino
Auto & Electronics

aspects of what they are doing, or how they are going to shape their career.” Hence, expanding their area of interest and having knowledge of the business aspect of the product or solution is very important. This aspect is something that young professionals tend to ignore as they strive to use their technical expertise alone.

“Apart from the technical skills, I think it is important to have the willingness to learn. The whole attitude is so important,” David adds. To take on higher challenges of the domain for any student or fresher, learning and upskilling needs should be the highest priority. For instance, becoming a better coder, learning the marketing aspects of IoT, or familiarising yourself with cloud services like AWS or Microsoft Azure is now easier with the help of the Internet.

Aspiring candidates must make full use of this opportunity. Dhaval Chhedha, VP, Engineering, Masai School, says, “Practical learning is something that you have to develop from within because it’s not going to happen. I don’t expect our educational system to change anytime soon, so students have to take up projects on their own.”

Solanki advises, “Go beyond the four walls of your house to attend events that speak of innovation. Remember the 3 C’s: Co-create, Co-invent, and Collaborate. IoT is such a field where no one company or team can build everything. Instances to work with competitors may arise as well. In early career stages, think of how you can collaborate with someone in your college to create a product together because you won’t be good at everything.”

For a senior professional

This exciting domain is not just limited to new talent, veterans and experienced professionals are needed as well in taking the industry forward. However, the switch from one industry to another, which is so dynamic and constantly evolving, may seem daunting.

Experience is the father of wisdom and, in that matter, someone with varied but still deep experience in one domain is an asset for any company. For instance, an individual who is very strong in sales, or in building partnerships, or managing a team of solution architects, needs to also have basic knowledge of how the other teams function. “With everything converging so fast, building depth in a couple of areas but breadth in many areas and having a T-shaped career is important. A person cannot just be a sales guy, but needs to also have a little knowledge concerning data security,” says Solanki.

While the aspiration of senior professionals to enter a new company by leading a particular team might be valid, David notes that it is important to have emphatic leadership. He goes on to say, “If you want to lead the team, you have to empathize with the hard working folks who are on the team. This reverse mentoring is very important.”

The lens through which the young professionals look at the world is one bright side of interaction between both senior and young professionals. It helps broaden horizons and understand what is going inside the minds of younger folks. As per Mittra, the ability to put together and run a team is needed in senior folks as it helps

build the right team and make them work on the solution together.

Chhedha says, senior professionals or leaders should be able to hire people who are smarter than themselves as that would not only make their task easier but also help in finding better solutions. However, he also adds, “The important thing in a leader is to know and understand what is happening around them and going past them. If not, things would start crumbling very fast and the leader would be taken for a ride.”

Crossing a certain threshold in one’s career does not mean that one should stop learning or assume having all the knowledge required to excel. Learning has to be a lifelong process since it will especially help someone trying to enter a new industry or domain. After 5-10 years of experience, it usually gets difficult to break the ice and get back to learning. Given that IoT can be deployed across pretty much any industry, aspiring professionals need not be confined to IT or telecom because there are enough and more opportunities in other industries also.

In conclusion, Solanki adds, “For those building their profile in this field, it is important that you understand the domain very well, and you also understand it is no longer required to work only in sunrise or so-called attractive industries. With the need of more digital people, I think there is no end to making your mark in this industry.” **EFY**

This article based on the panel discussion titled ‘Career Guidance - What are the Latest IoT Jobs and How to Prepare For Them?’ held during June edition of Tech World Congress 2021 has been prepared by Siddha Dhar, a business journalist at EFY.